



The U.S. gov't. creates own font

The US government has released a new set of tools dubbed the U.S. Web Design System 2.0.
<https://digit.in/may19-65>



Facebook testing font styles

According to reports, Facebook is testing a new 'Text effects' option for News Feed posts.
<https://digit.in/may19-66>

Humanist movement was blocked by the counter-impulses of the Reformation. The third major type family also had its origins in the writings of the scribes. The italic was generated by the clerks and chancellery that wrote in fast, informal, cursive letters to speed up their work. The italics came about and popularised pocketbooks due to their ability to fit more words into a single page.

Once the movable type letter-press came about, with it came new typefaces. Higher sophistication in the moulding technology available led to greater contrasts between thick and thin strokes and more delicate serif tails. Visually, there was greater importance of the horizontal axis. All of this was collectively known as the Old Style, which, contrary to its name, was mostly the first modern-looking typeface. A few examples would be Goudy Old Style, Palantino, and Cheltenham.

Taking the Old Style a step further, around the beginning of the 18th century, the transitional styles came to be. This represented a move away entirely from the handwritten feel of previous typefaces. The mechanical



Typesetting the metal movable type sorts was hard work!

look had set in since it represented efficiency and progress. The thin strokes got even thinner, and the thick strokes became thicker. The serif tails became even more prominent and everything was either horizontal or vertical. Baskerville, Times New Roman, Georgia are three well-known examples. Even though they are 300

Typefaces in this mag:

- Farnham Display - Serif, Old Style; released in 2004 by Font Beaureu and designed by Christian Schwartz.
- Titillium Web - Sans Serif, Modern; released by the Accademia di Belle Arti di Urbino as a didactic project
- Khand - Sans Serif, designed by Satya Rajpurohit (Latin)
- Changa One - Sans Serif, Neo-humanist, released in 2016, designed by Eduardo Tunni**

years old, we still use transitional styles everyday.

Even though early typefaces resembling the modern style were designed as early as the 18th century, they didn't catch on properly until the 20th century. The first modern style typeface was created by Italian printer Giambattista Bodoni and it appeared all the way back in 1784. The Modern Style took the transitional idea to the extreme with super-thick thick parts and hair-thin thin strokes.

Serifs became abrupt, nearly at right angles with the letters themselves. Currently, this typeface and font families are associated with high fashion and luxury. Examples are Bodoni, Didot, Walbaum.

When the 19th century came around, new use cases for the printed letter emerged. So far, printed letters were mainly intended for reading from books, or interfaces of similar dimensions. However, around the beginning of the 1800s, advertisements, posters and newspaper headlines opened up requirements for a new type of typeface – something designed to catch your eye. To fulfil this requirement, the Slab serif style

of typefaces came about. They feature an upgrade to the Modern style with stroked thickened up with fat, block-like strokes. In the same period, the typewriter was invented and popularised. Most typewriter typefaces are slabs. Additionally, typewriters also brought about the concept of monospacing to typefaces. Essentially, monospacing means forming a typeface where every glyph occupies the same space. Some known examples would be Clarendon, Rockwell, Playbill, Courier.

So horrid was the idea of ditching the serifs on typefaces that Sans Serif typefaces were initially known as grotesques because people found them ugly. "Sans" in French means without. The removal of the serif wasn't taken too well initially. However, gradually, three major categories of Sans Serif emerged:

- Neo-grotesques (aka transitional, realist): Plain and easy to read; the famous Helvetica is one of these.
- Humanists: Slightly more calligraphic; they include Calibri, Lucida Sans and Verdana.
- Geometrics: Distinctly modern feel by being based entirely on geometric shapes; Futura and Century Gothic are examples.

There are typefaces that evolved beyond this as well, with the advent of digital technology. Script typefaces directly mimic handwriting and calligraphy. There are typefaces that mimic other languages as well but are essentially writing the Roman alphabet. For instance, Faux Hebrew is a good example. Then you have ornamental typefaces with all kinds of flourishes as well.

A popular question by our readers is to ask what font/typeface the Digit logo is written in. The answer, of course, is that it's not a typeface or a font at all, but is in fact something we created as a logo. However, we're considering making our own font with our logo style. If that's something that interests you, write in to editor@digit.in and demand it, and we'll see what we can do. 